

Participant I

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 00:42

How do you define open science?

00:51

I define it as accessible scientific information for everyone with no barriers in cost, or accessibility in terms of technology. So no financial and no technological barriers or any other barriers for everyone to see scientific information. That's a bit and packed. But that's the umbrella we use.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 01:25

That's great. Could you say just a few more words about the accessibility to technology piece? Like how do you conceptualize that part?

01:33

Yeah, so making scientific information available for free online is amazing, and can remove a lot of the cost barriers that other researchers and patients and everybody around the world can get to. But we also have to realize that not everybody has access to the internet, not everybody has access to a machine where they can connect and see the scientific information. So in my mind, to have complete open science, we should also provide a venue or a space where everyone can access information, not necessarily from their homes, but perhaps from hospitals, or public libraries, or other institutions. And these can be government or academic, where folks can go in and see information if they don't have that infrastructure at home.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 02:37

Awesome. Okay, that's great. Thank you. And here's Question four, what is your experience with open science practices? How do you interact with them?

02:50

Okay, that's a good question. So, I always think of my experience with open science as a librarian. So I would describe my experience as in the instruction section, so teaching our students about open science, and publishing and open access journals, informing them of author guidelines and APCs. And informing them if they have any discounts. So I see my role as librarian as informing people about their open science options that they may have as a researcher or as a student publishing their research. I also access open science, accessible information as part of my work in terms of helping others retrieve articles that they need. So sharing of links, also making available guides online, and having free resources. So for example, we have a guide that is for [graduates] and who are not not affiliated with the university, so they have access to very little. So we put together a guide for them or where they can go to get free information for evidence based [discipline]. So I see as informing people where to go to get open resources, but also from the perspective of publishing their research where they can publish, but also I don't know what will the second part about how do you interact with them? I don't know if I'm answering it correctly. So I guess it would be the practices would be to inform and, and let people know and how I interact with them would be either by teaching or by creating guides for people to do it themselves, to look at the guide and go and access free information that they may need. Now I'm only going to talk about the piece within my role, but I do use Open Science myself as a patient. And as someone who looks up medical information for myself and for my family, and so that piece is different than my role as librarian. But that brings up another point. It is just accessing information to inform myself or other members of my family have both a certain disease for example, or treatment, or

procedure that they have to have. So in that way I interact with just like the normal person would, so through Google wikipedia, PubMed, and anything else that will provide free information at the patient level.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 06:01

Right on, awesome. Yeah. And you answered that question perfectly. Thank you for giving both your personal experience and your professional one. Okay. And where do you learn about open science practices?

06:15

This is a bit trickier. That's a good question. So I rely on the copyright office, they have a page on if there is any discounts for our researchers, when they're able to publish open access resources. So I use their website heavily. I also, anytime they offer workshops, on copyright, I attend. About open science in general, I don't currently have a venue, I kind of do it on my own for [discipline]. So I often see if there are any [discipline] repositories for data, for example, which are very few. And I see if there's anything new. In that regard, as I update my lectures, mostly, I look for any changes in venues where they could deposit information or data, the results from the research to be accessible for free. So I do a little bit of either taking workshops, or just on my own, just, you know, trying to find out if anything has changed in the landscape of [discipline]. And then, of course, for my colleagues, so the Open Science roadmap to research series [...] And then finally, just going through websites like the Government of Ontario and seeing what they're doing. CIHR has a knowledge management action plan, actually, that they're rolling out. And so since I'm aware of that, I look to see if there's any open science pieces in there, because it will impact libraries. And so whenever I see an initiative like that, that's sort of at the federal level, I always try to see if there's any documents posted and see if there's anything related to open science that would impact libraries.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 08:57

Awesome, right on. Sounds like you have a lot of feelers in the space.

09:02

I always feel like I'm not doing enough though to learn and stay up to date.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 09:08

I mean, there's a lot to know. Okay, awesome. So I put question six in the chat, but this is the point where I will share my screen. So I'll read the question in just a sec. So this is a multi part question. The first part of the question is we'll just discuss if there are any barriers that prevent you from adopting open science in your work. And then we can look at this list together. This is a list that came out of a study conducted in Australia. And researchers were asked what barriers they experienced to conducting open science. So you can see if any of these resonate with you, and then if there are any barriers, you can mention how you might overcome them or what could help you overcome them.

09:56

Okay, Should I think librarianship or [discipline]? Because those are two different things? Because I can already see the difference.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 10:09

Yeah, that's a really good point. I mean, if it's helpful, Question seven is asking about other researchers and other faculty members. If it's conceptually helpful, you could think of this one as your role as a

librarian. And then when we get to question seven, you could think about other researchers in your discipline.

10:30

Okay, that sounds okay, I'll start with librarianship then for this one. And if particularly, you know, I've always been a [discipline] librarian And so that's the only thing that I know. And that's the only thing that I can speak to. So, I guess, yeah, these are tricky. Sorry, I have to just look at this for a moment. Yeah, I don't see any major sort of issues for me. I'll speak to I guess, number 10 and 11. I find that difficult sometimes, to engage in open science practices with my colleagues, like I can do it here at industry, I can inform like, I can embed open science resources in my instructions and create guides. But I feel like there should almost be like a committee for open science or to deal with these kinds of things, and maybe have folks from the copyright office, I think it will be great for folks who want to learn more like me. And I think, I think I also will point to number 11. It's something that I do very little of when I'm sort of updating my slides. But I feel like I always should do more. And I'm not sure how to fit it into my schedule. So it's a time for me as well. So to both engage, and to learn, so I would say 10 and 11, for sure. And I also I guess I don't know if this is typical librarian, but I feel I always lack expertise. I feel like I should be learning more and then maybe learning more by doing so either taking part in other open science initiatives across campus to learn a little bit more. So I do feel number 12 as well. Let me see here. This is a tricky one, too. So I this speaks to [discipline], I guess. So 14, students are discouraged from engaging in open science practices by thesis supervisor, I can speak to that a lot of [discipline] journals are not fully open. And we still run on the traditional model of publishing into journals that are high impact factor, or that are considered very valuable by the either [discipline] in general of the sub specialty. And so there is a little bit of this that I see in my work. So 14, for sure. It's just a it's a mixture of the traditional model of publishing and those journals, but also the lack of opportunity for open access [discipline] journals that are around it gives students really not very many choices of where to publish. So I don't think it's so much their thesis supervisor, although in some cases it is. But it's just the lack of options that they have [example of discipline journals] and a few others, there's not a lot of [discipline] journals that are fully open. Let me see here. What else can I say? I don't think that yeah, no, 15 Not at all. Anytime that I've reached out to anybody, it's not been an issue not intimidating. Yeah. Okay, so this is a tricky one as well. Number 17. When we do outreach when we have done outreach in the past, for example, if we do outreach on open access week at the end of October, there has been very little interest from our faculty members to to discuss or have a conversation about open access. And I'm not sure sure that it's a lack of interest from them personally, but I think some of them struggle to see how the library fits in that conversation. And it's not until they actually talk to us that they realize that we do have some knowledge and that we can help them. But unfortunately, a lot of the researchers that I have come across, they are surprised to even think of the library as somebody that they would go to for open science type of questions or support. That is all I'm going to speak to, I think, for this part.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 15:44

Fantastic. Okay, awesome. So I will put question seven in the chat, just so you can reference it. But I think you have started to answer this one. So maybe I'll just prompt you to consider are there any things that you think could support either someone in your role or another student, faculty member, even administrators from overcoming some barriers that come up in pursuing open science?

16:15

Yeah, cost is definitely a barrier. And I think the libraries are already doing a great job with providing discounts or waiving the APC fees. I hope that can continue. Again, I don't know the specifics of how difficult it was to set that up, I assume it was very difficult both in time and in sort of an administrative

tasks. But I feel like cost is a barrier, lack of knowledge, I think is a barrier as well, about why should I put my research open access? Why should I pay? You know, \$2000-3,000 to have my article published, right, in an open access journal? So there is a lack of knowledge there? And what could help overcome? I'm not sure. I think we do have to think about brainstorming, on just informing researchers, faculty, students, that we can support open science, and we do have a copyright office. And they can provide support and help with finding discounts for example, even though we tell our faculty members about the discounts. And there's a lot of them, who simply don't read our email blasts, and our newsletters, and they're always surprised. And so I'm not sure how to do that, I think the best way for the library to succeed in that is perhaps by partnering... and they may be doing this already, and I don't know... but perhaps partnering with the research ethics office. Or some other office, I'm not sure. But research ethics, I think is a natural partnership. So when you submit your proposal to run a study, now it's done online, perhaps just having a pop up or resources with within my research online, that link to some of these discounts for publishing, and thus encouraging open science. Other things to remove knowledge barriers may be, you know, other series about open science to open up discussions, but perhaps not having the planning of it as being library only. Perhaps partnering with another office that has more interaction with faculty members. So that it's advertised in a different way, not as a library discussion. Because I have a feeling that... we had a great turnout. But I think going broader in the administration may help us get more numbers and numbers outside of the libraries to join in that conversation. So I've talked about cost and lack of knowledge. Those are things to the main barriers. The other thing here at [discipline], of course, it is actually not just [discipline], but there is a still a little bit of stigma to open science in terms of sharing information that maybe a sort of, I don't know what to say this, an intellectual property concern that the researchers may have. But that is so I think, inviting experts in the field, maybe to speak to that, that it's okay, would be a great idea just to remove some of the stigma about why should I put my research out there freely available. So not understanding that this is something that's already published. So it's okay great to have a really accessible, you're not giving away any secrets here. It's stuff that you're going to publish anyway. But maybe getting rid of some of the stigma, especially in the clinical side of things, I think would help. I think that's all I want to say about that. Yeah.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 20:55

Yeah, those are great responses. Awesome. So I can stop sharing my screen now. And I will share question eight, which you've already spoken to, but you can kind of, say as much more as much as you'd like to on this topic. So do you offer research support relating to open science practices? If so, what type of support do you offer? And at what stage in the research cycle?

21:21

Yeah, so I offer very little support here locally. So again, in my lectures, I always try to include at least one slide with a link to where they can publish, where they can deposit their data. But that is my extent of sort of that in the instruction piece. I oftentimes... very few reference questions about "where should I publish?" So I offer support and instruction in reference. And as you know, we do systematic reviews here. But I am more of the role of support not collaborators, so supporting grad students with getting systematic reviews, other knowledge synthesis, and other types of studies, qualitative, more and more. And so anytime I do that sort of thing I always try to provide our students with a list of, or just the link to our Open Science page. And if it's a question outside of my knowledge area, I often use the copyright office, their website, or even providing the email address where they can find further support that I cannot provide. The research cycle, I would say, it varies, like sometimes I get folks right at the protocol stage. And other times, they're a little bit further along. Or other times they're ready to publish, they have this thing and they want to know where should they go? So I think it's a little bit I would say mostly

it's at the beginning. And so the protocol stage, but I do get some questions later on in the research cycle. So yeah, it kind of varies.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 23:20

Okay, perfect. Thank you. And in your opinion, how important are open science initiatives at the University of Toronto?

23:30

Oh, I cannot stress how important it is to continue with initiatives, just keep going with it and keep doing different venues. It doesn't have to be talks. It could be email blasts. But one thing I will say is that the partnership I think is very important. So not doing it by ourselves in the libraries, but reaching out to other offices that have access to faculty members, I think is a great idea. And, you know, as I said, the research office, my research online, different venues, explore the different offices and partner with them rather than doing it on our own. But the initiatives themselves are extremely important. I would even go as far as maybe looking at some of the conferences, the Open Science conferences, and perhaps offering a little bit of money for a student to attend virtually, or submit a poster. Not necessarily a library student but a student in the sciences. Or it could be a library student but even just supporting the dissemination of information at that stage to generate some sort of discussion or even just awareness. Students would say, oh, "there's an open science conference? And I never thought of that. But the library is doing this contest. I can win and present." Something like that. But again, I think it's really important to try them out. And if they fail, they fail. But the initiatives are very, very important. We should keep going with them.